

Joel Hunt

Senior Full-Stack Engineer | UX Product Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack and UX product engineer with 6 years of experience taking web products from Figma to production. Most recently Director of Product Engineering at Bulqit, a home-services marketplace, where I was one of two in-house engineers: I took over a codebase inherited from a dismissed agency, rebuilt its front end, and took the platform through public launch. In five months I completed 646 Linear issues and merged 454 pull requests across React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js and PostgreSQL, and built the company's end-to-end test suite, CI quality gates, security fixes and performance work. A design background means the interfaces I build match the design system, meet WCAG 2.1 accessibility standards, and measurably change what users do.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES2023), SQL, PHP, Ruby, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend: React 19, Next.js 16 (App Router, Server Components, Server Actions), Tailwind CSS 4, Bootstrap 5, Radix UI / shadcn/ui, Redux Toolkit, Storybook

Backend & Data: Node.js, REST APIs, PostgreSQL (Neon), Drizzle ORM, Temporal workflows, Stripe, Clerk auth, Sanity CMS, Algolia, Kirby CMS, Magento 2, Moodle / Totara

Cloud & DevOps: Vercel, Fly.io, Docker, CI/CD with GitHub Actions, Turborepo, Google Maps Platform, Twilio, SendGrid

Testing & Quality: Playwright, Vitest, Testing Library, Cypress, Sentry, Lighthouse

Security: Authorization and access control, JWT / JWKS single sign-on, Content-Security-Policy, rate limiting, PII protection

Design & UX: Figma, design systems and design tokens, WCAG 2.1 accessibility, responsive design, usability testing, prototyping

Practices: Agile, Linear, Jira, code review, AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Hermes, OpenCode, Ollama), technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Product Engineering, Bulqit

May 2026 – Oct 2026

Home-services marketplace connecting homeowners with vendors for recurring services. Five-person startup; one of two in-house engineers after an external agency handoff. Soft launch Jul 2026, public launch Aug 2026; the company wound down in Oct 2026.

- **Stabilized a codebase inherited from a dismissed agency**, with broken checkout, coupons, SMS number masking and email delivery. Owned the front-end recovery and personally resolved ~350 user and QA feedback reports, including ~130 left open from before I joined; 898 of the 902 reports filed during my tenure were resolved before wind-down.
- **Led the pre-launch product redesign**, building the lead designer's Figma system in Next.js and React across the vendor app, member app and marketing site: about 28 pull requests over 45 routes in five weeks, to WCAG 2.1 and responsive requirements. Closed 300+ UI, UX and usability tickets across the vendor, member and admin apps.
- **Drove vendor activation through product design**: rebuilt the core vendor workflows (scheduling calendar, field-staff jobs, bidding, inbox, homes) and shipped guided onboarding with dashboard action items. About 75% of ~45 vendor signups submitted insurance and compliance documents with no staff follow-up, producing 31 approved vendors.
- **Moved the front end onto Figma design tokens** across 619 files, with a lint rule against hard-coded colors. After launch, merged four competing type systems into Figma text styles (728 files) and upgraded to Tailwind CSS 4 with no visual regressions.
- **Led a Lighthouse performance and accessibility push** across 12 public pages, measured as medians of three production runs: average mobile Performance 75 to 85, desktop 94 to 99. On the vendor landing page, mobile Performance rose from 53 to 86, Total Blocking Time fell from 17.2 s to 0.2 s, and page weight from 5.7 MB to 1.7 MB. Every page scores 91+ for Accessibility and 100 for SEO.
- **Replaced a Cypress suite that checked nothing with a Playwright end-to-end suite** that builds the app, seeds its own database and walks seven user roles from signup to card payment: 113 tests, run in CI on every pull request.
- **Co-ran an AI-assisted security audit** with the Director of Operations Engineering (16 findings: 3 urgent, 4 high; 10 resolved by wind-down), and independently found and closed authorization flaws: vendor payouts without ownership checks, vendor-account takeover by email, and an API route serving private conversations without authorization. Each fix shipped with a CI guard test that fails if the flaw returns.
- **Caught three billing defects before release** in the Stripe and PostgreSQL charge path (duplicate charges from concurrent job completions, coupons applied only to the first visit, unbilled units on count-priced services): zero billing errors in production across ~80 recurring services a month and \$5.8K in card payments.

- **Directed launch QA:** wrote persona-based test cases and checklist flows for every user role, and ran up to five external testers plus internal staff through each release; several releases returned zero defect reports. Zero downtime on core web systems from launch to wind-down.
- **Led technical discovery for an SSO partnership** with a neighbourhood-app partner and wrote the integration spec: a signed JWT / JWKS handoff so partner users arrive already authenticated and placed in their verified neighbourhood. The partner accepted the spec; the company wound down before implementation.
- **Built the email-driven reporting pipeline for partner Blue Ocean:** a vendor's report email marks the job complete, takes payment and forwards a branded report to the homeowner. Also built the migration flow that moved Blue Ocean's existing customers onto the platform without a signup.
- **Ran issue triage and delivery in Linear and Sentry with the COO:** completed 646 issues in five months. In the final release cycle, which Linear scoped at 487% of team capacity, the team completed 154 of 195 issues (79%), 83 of them mine.
- **Designed a parallel AI-agent development workflow,** running several coding agents in separate git worktrees, which produced a large share of my 454 merged pull requests (49% of everything merged to the main branch). Wrote 23 of the repository's 39 CI guard tests and the team's engineering handbook so agent-written code was checked automatically, not only in review.

Full Stack Developer (Contract), FiveQ

Apr 2025 – May 2026

- Built a reusable Algolia search plugin for FiveQ's Kirby CMS platform, deployed to 3+ client sites, including a bespoke school-finder map for Humanitas Institute serving 1,000+ records with sub-200 ms responses.
- Designed and built the live player and integrated programme schedule for Life Changing Radio, a regional broadcaster running six stations from one website.
- Wrote a reusable audio and video player plugin in PHP, Tailwind CSS and JavaScript with Google Analytics tracking, and set up a CI pipeline with Cypress automated tests.

Product Designer, Goodheart-Willcox

May 2024 – Aug 2024

- Rebuilt 25+ image-based accounting ledgers as accessible, interactive HTML tables for the G-W Ignite Accounting course, turning static figures into a quiz tool shipped to students in the LMS.
- Built prototypes for G-W Ignite courses (Accounting, Clinical, Employability Skills) with the product team, and supported the rollout of a new assessment tool in an Agile, Jira-tracked team.

UX Developer, Synergy Learning

May 2023 – Apr 2024

- Built and redesigned compliance-training portals on Moodle and Totara for enterprise clients, including a redesigned theme for Ryanair used by all staff, the member portal for the Association of the British Pharmaceutical Industry (ABPI), and a platform version upgrade for Suzuki Deutschland.
- Refined designs through usability testing, wrote documentation for internal and client stakeholders, estimated work, and explained web best practices to non-technical staff.

Web Designer, Visionworks Interactive

Nov 2021 – May 2023

- Designed and co-built the UI/UX redesign of a 15,000+ product Magento 2 e-commerce store, owning the design end to end and splitting implementation with one other developer.
- Ran the server infrastructure for 40+ client WordPress sites, and built responsive client websites in HTML, CSS, JavaScript and PHP from requirements to launch.

Web Designer, MarketUs Group

May 2020 – Nov 2021

- Designed and built responsive client websites across industries, covering design, animation, video and pre-launch QA.

EDUCATION

Software Developer Program (480+ hours), Discovery Partners Institute

Oct 2024 – Oct 2025

Full-stack program in Ruby on Rails, Sinatra, SQL and REST APIs; built a Qualtrics-to-Salesforce ELT web application.

Bachelor of Arts, Theological Studies, University of Cumbria (Belfast Bible College)

2021